The current health of your build and the build history are default data points your CI system provides. You can also get results from test runs or whatever build steps you define. But if you want to answer more interesting questions like the ones I posed at the beginning of the chapter like

- How fast can you deliver code to the consumer?
- Are your estimations accurate?
- Are you getting tasks done right the first time?
- How much is your team actually getting done?

then you should use the following tips to ensure you're generating the richest set of data you can.

5.2.1. Set up a delivery pipeline

A delivery pipeline goes beyond your build scripts. Once your product is tested, built, and staged, other coordination typically has to happen. You may need to kick off tests for dependent systems, deploy code with environment-specific parameters based on test results, or combine parallel builds of different parts of your larger system for a complete deployment. Automating more complex build and deploy scenarios can be tricky and is exactly what your pipeline specializes in. By automating your complex build process, you can get data out of your pipeline that tells you how fast you're delivering products to your consumers. When you break down that data point, you can also find where you can make the most improvement to deliver products faster and more efficiently.

If you have a CI system in place, that's great; everything you did in the last section should just plug in and start generating reports for you. If you don't, we recommend taking a look at Jenkins or GoCD (www.go.cd/) for your pipeline. GoCD is a CI system like Jenkins or TeamCity, and all of them are capable of building your code, running your tests, and generating reports that you can bring into your metrics collection system. The cool thing about GoCD is the idea of a pipeline as a first-class citizen, so breaking your build/deploy into steps that are easy to visualize is completely standard and normal. Jenkins is extremely popular and can do pipeline management using plugins.